



BE READY.

Pre-season

# Your sessions

Power + Muscle development

Program

**Pre-season**

Duration

**8 weeks**

Session

**45 to 60 min**

Place

**Home**

For personal use only, do not share. This program is for people in good health: if you feel pain, have an injury or are in doubt, stop and ask a health professional for advice.

# Your goals

## Power

Power is force multiplied by speed. A jump shot, a duel at pivot or a first step all require producing a lot of force in a fraction of a second.

- **Push heavy:** increase your maximum strength with heavy loads and few reps.
- **Move fast:** turn that strength into fast movements (throws, jumps, pushes).
- **Link the two:** pair a heavy exercise with a similar fast movement (contrast method).

### The golden rules

- **Few reps, lots of rest:** 3 to 5 reps, 2 to 3 minutes of recovery.
- **Every rep at maximum speed,** even with a heavy load: the intent is what counts.
- Heavy loads only if your technique is perfect.

**At home:** the load comes from a weighted backpack (books, water bottles), a handball or a band, and from single-leg variations.

## Muscle development

In handball, you take contacts in every attack and every defence. Stronger muscles protect your joints and make you harder to knock off balance.

- **Strength:** pushing, pulling and lifting heavier.
- **Mass gain:** building muscle size.
- **Core and stability:** transferring force from your legs to your arm and staying stable in contacts.

### The golden rules

- **Technique first:** a load only goes up if the movement stays clean.
- **Progress a little every week:** one more rep, or a slightly heavier load.
- **Control the descent:** 2 to 3 seconds down, then back up with energy.
- Keep 2 to 3 reps in reserve: never train to failure.

**Mass gain:** training sends the signal, but muscles are built with food and sleep. Eat enough, with protein at every meal, and sleep 8 hours. For nutrition advice, see a registered dietitian.

**At home:** without heavy loads, the exercise gets harder when you slow down the descent, add a weighted backpack or switch to one leg. This is why there are more reps.



**Important: watch each exercise's animation before doing it.** Tap the eye next to its name. The animation shows what the text cannot: the exact position, the direction of the movement, the rhythm and the footwork. Do not just read the program, especially for an exercise you do not know: this is what makes every session effective and safe.

## How to read your sessions

- Every session is written out in full, in order: do the steps from top to bottom.
- "2-4 × 8": 2 sets at level 1, 3 at level 2, 4 at level 3, of 8 reps. "2-3 × 8": 2 sets at levels 1 and 2, 3 at level 3.
- The number in front of each exercise refers to its illustrated sheet, at the end of this document.
- If you do not know your level, read the guide again, page "Choosing your level".

## Weeks 1-2 · Getting started

Get your body used to effort again and learn the movements. Effort 5-6 out of 10.

Power: moderate loads to learn the movements, light throws.

Muscle development: light loads, learning the movements.

# Session A

## 1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

|   |                                                                                                                     |                  |           |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|-----------|
| 1 | Light jog and running drills                                                                                        | 3 min            |           |
| 2 |  Forward lunge with trunk rotation | 6 per side       |           |
| 3 |  Walking hip opener                | 8 per side       |           |
| 4 |  Glute bridge                      | 2 × 10           | 15 s      |
| 5 |  Plank                             | 2 × 20 s         | 15 s      |
| 6 |  Single-leg balance                | 2 × 20 s per leg |           |
| 7 |  Small jump, stable landing        | 2 × 5            | 20 s      |
| 8 | Progressive accelerations                                                                                           | 3 runs           | walk back |

## 2 POWER

15-20 min

|    |                                                                                                         |                       |       |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|-------|
| 9  |  Squat                 | 2-3 × 9 · 3 s descent | 2 min |
| 10 |  Two-handed ball throw | 2-3 × 5               | 60 s  |

## 3 MUSCLE DEVELOPMENT

15-20 min

|    |                                                                                              |                        |      |
|----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|------|
| 9  |  Squat     | 2-3 × 15 · 3 s descent | 75 s |
| 11 |  Push-ups | 2-3 × 10               | 60 s |

## 4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

|    |                                                                                                           |                     |      |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|------|
| 5  |  Plank                 | 2-4 × 30 s          | 30 s |
| 12 |  Side plank            | 2-3 × 20 s per side | 20 s |
| 13 |  Nordic hamstring curl | 2-3 × 4             | 60 s |

## 5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

## Session B

### 1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

|   |                                                                                                                     |                  |           |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|-----------|
| 1 | Light jog and running drills                                                                                        | 3 min            |           |
| 2 |  Forward lunge with trunk rotation | 6 per side       |           |
| 3 |  Walking hip opener                | 8 per side       |           |
| 4 |  Glute bridge                      | 2 × 10           | 15 s      |
| 5 |  Plank                             | 2 × 20 s         | 15 s      |
| 6 |  Single-leg balance                | 2 × 20 s per leg |           |
| 7 |  Small jump, stable landing        | 2 × 5            | 20 s      |
| 8 | Progressive accelerations                                                                                           | 3 runs           | walk back |

### 2 POWER

15-20 min

|    |                                                                                                    |                |      |
|----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|------|
| 14 |  Hip thrust       | 2-3 × 12       | 90 s |
| 15 |  Rotational throw | 2 × 5 per side | 60 s |

### 3 MUSCLE DEVELOPMENT

15-20 min

|    |                                                                                                              |                  |      |
|----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|------|
| 16 |  Romanian deadlift         | 2-3 × 10 per leg | 75 s |
| 17 |  Inverted row             | 2-3 × 12         | 60 s |
| 18 |  Plank with shoulder taps | 2 × 10 per side  | 30 s |

### 4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

|    |                                                                                                         |                  |      |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|------|
| 19 |  Dead bug            | 2-3 × 8 per side | 30 s |
| 20 |  Y-T-W               | 2-3 × 8          | 30 s |
| 21 |  Balance with a ball | 2 × 30 s per leg | 20 s |

### 5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

## Session C

### 1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

|   |                                                                                                                     |                  |           |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|-----------|
| 1 | Light jog and running drills                                                                                        | 3 min            |           |
| 2 |  Forward lunge with trunk rotation | 6 per side       |           |
| 3 |  Walking hip opener                | 8 per side       |           |
| 4 |  Glute bridge                      | 2 × 10           | 15 s      |
| 5 |  Plank                             | 2 × 20 s         | 15 s      |
| 6 |  Single-leg balance                | 2 × 20 s per leg |           |
| 7 |  Small jump, stable landing        | 2 × 5            | 20 s      |
| 8 | Progressive accelerations                                                                                           | 3 runs           | walk back |

### 2 POWER

15-20 min

|    |                                                                                                     |          |       |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-------|
| 22 |  Weighted push-ups | 2-3 × 12 | 2 min |
| 23 |  Box jump          | 2-3 × 4  | 75 s  |

### 3 MUSCLE DEVELOPMENT

15-20 min

|    |                                                                                                   |                                |      |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|------|
| 24 |  Reverse lunge  | 2-3 × 12 per leg · 3 s descent | 60 s |
| 25 |  Pike push-ups | 2-3 × 10                       | 60 s |

### 4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

|    |                                                                                                                     |                     |      |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|------|
| 26 |  Single-leg glute bridge         | 2-3 × 10 per leg    | 30 s |
| 27 |  Copenhagen plank (knee version) | 2-3 × 15 s per side | 30 s |
| 28 |  Shoulder external rotation      | 2-3 × 12 per arm    | 30 s |

### 5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

Week after week, you can add the optional bonus session:

## Session D (bonus, optional) - 20 min

### 1 WARM-UP

10 min

|   |                                                                                                                     |                  |           |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|-----------|
| 1 | Light jog and running drills                                                                                        | 3 min            |           |
| 2 |  Forward lunge with trunk rotation | 6 per side       |           |
| 3 |  Walking hip opener                | 8 per side       |           |
| 4 |  Glute bridge                      | 2 × 10           | 15 s      |
| 5 |  Plank                             | 2 × 20 s         | 15 s      |
| 6 |  Single-leg balance                | 2 × 20 s per leg |           |
| 7 |  Small jump, stable landing        | 2 × 5            | 20 s      |
| 8 | Progressive accelerations                                                                                           | 3 runs           | walk back |

### 2 PREVENTION AND MOBILITY

10 min

|    |                                                                                                                |                   |      |
|----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|------|
| 5  |  Plank                        | 2 × 30 s          | 30 s |
| 12 |  Side plank                   | 2 × 20 s per side | 20 s |
| 13 |  Nordic hamstring curl        | 2 × 3             | 60 s |
| 29 |  90/90 hip mobility          | 1 × 8 per side    |      |
| 30 |  Ankle mobility at the wall | 1 × 10 per side   |      |
| 31 |  Upper back rotation        | 1 × 8 per side    |      |

## Weeks 3-5 - Building up

Increase the loads gradually. Week 5 is the heaviest. Effort 7-8 out of 10.

**Power:** this is the phase where you push heavy, increase the loads every week.

**Muscle development:** this is the key phase, increase the loads every week. If your goal is mass gain, do 8 to 12 reps with 60 to 90 s of rest.

# Session A

## 1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

|   |                                                                                                                     |                  |           |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|-----------|
| 1 | Light jog and running drills                                                                                        | 3 min            |           |
| 2 |  Forward lunge with trunk rotation | 6 per side       |           |
| 3 |  Walking hip opener                | 8 per side       |           |
| 4 |  Glute bridge                      | 2 × 10           | 15 s      |
| 5 |  Plank                             | 2 × 20 s         | 15 s      |
| 6 |  Single-leg balance                | 2 × 20 s per leg |           |
| 7 |  Small jump, stable landing        | 2 × 5            | 20 s      |
| 8 | Progressive accelerations                                                                                           | 3 runs           | walk back |

## 2 POWER

15-20 min

|    |                                                                                                                  |                                  |       |
|----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-------|
| 32 |  Weighted Bulgarian split squat | 3-4 × 8-10 per leg · 3 s descent | 3 min |
| 10 |  Two-handed ball throw          | 3 × 5                            | 75 s  |

## 3 MUSCLE DEVELOPMENT

15-20 min

|    |                                                                                                   |                          |       |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-------|
| 9  |  Squat         | 3-4 × 9-12 · 3 s descent | 2 min |
| 11 |  Push-ups      | 3-4 × 8                  | 90 s  |
| 33 |  Farmer's walk | 3 × 20 m                 | 60 s  |

## 4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

|    |                                                                                                           |                     |      |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|------|
| 5  |  Plank                 | 2-4 × 30 s          | 30 s |
| 12 |  Side plank            | 2-3 × 20 s per side | 20 s |
| 13 |  Nordic hamstring curl | 2-3 × 4             | 60 s |

## 5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

## Session B

### 1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

|   |                                                                                                                     |                  |           |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|-----------|
| 1 | Light jog and running drills                                                                                        | 3 min            |           |
| 2 |  Forward lunge with trunk rotation | 6 per side       |           |
| 3 |  Walking hip opener                | 8 per side       |           |
| 4 |  Glute bridge                      | 2 × 10           | 15 s      |
| 5 |  Plank                             | 2 × 20 s         | 15 s      |
| 6 |  Single-leg balance                | 2 × 20 s per leg |           |
| 7 |  Small jump, stable landing        | 2 × 5            | 20 s      |
| 8 | Progressive accelerations                                                                                           | 3 runs           | walk back |

### 2 POWER

15-20 min

|    |                                                                                                             |                                            |       |
|----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|-------|
| 34 |  Single-leg hip thrust     | 3-4 × 10 per leg · 2 s<br>pause at the top | 2 min |
| 35 |  Inverted row, feet raised | 3 × 7                                      | 2 min |
| 15 |  Rotational throw         | 3 × 4 per side                             | 60 s  |

### 3 MUSCLE DEVELOPMENT

15-20 min

|    |                                                                                                              |                 |      |
|----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|------|
| 14 |  Hip thrust               | 3-4 × 12        | 90 s |
| 36 |  Pull-ups (or row)        | 3-4 × 6-8       | 90 s |
| 18 |  Plank with shoulder taps | 3 × 10 per side | 30 s |

### 4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

|    |                                                                                                         |                  |      |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|------|
| 19 |  Dead bug            | 2-3 × 8 per side | 30 s |
| 20 |  Y-T-W               | 2-3 × 8          | 30 s |
| 21 |  Balance with a ball | 2 × 30 s per leg | 20 s |

### 5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

## Session C

### 1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

|   |                                                                                                                     |                  |           |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|-----------|
| 1 | Light jog and running drills                                                                                        | 3 min            |           |
| 2 |  Forward lunge with trunk rotation | 6 per side       |           |
| 3 |  Walking hip opener                | 8 per side       |           |
| 4 |  Glute bridge                      | 2 × 10           | 15 s      |
| 5 |  Plank                             | 2 × 20 s         | 15 s      |
| 6 |  Single-leg balance                | 2 × 20 s per leg |           |
| 7 |  Small jump, stable landing        | 2 × 5            | 20 s      |
| 8 | Progressive accelerations                                                                                           | 3 runs           | walk back |

### 2 POWER

15-20 min

|    |                                                                                                     |            |       |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|-------|
| 22 |  Weighted push-ups | 3-4 × 8-10 | 3 min |
| 23 |  Box jump          | 3 × 4      | 90 s  |

### 3 MUSCLE DEVELOPMENT

15-20 min

|    |                                                                                                                            |                              |      |
|----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|------|
| 37 |  Bulgarian split squat (with a backpack) | 3 × 10 per leg · 3 s descent | 90 s |
| 16 |  Romanian deadlift                      | 3 × 8 per leg                | 90 s |
| 25 |  Pike push-ups                          | 3 × 8                        | 75 s |

### 4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

|    |                                                                                                                     |                     |      |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|------|
| 26 |  Single-leg glute bridge         | 2-3 × 10 per leg    | 30 s |
| 27 |  Copenhagen plank (knee version) | 2-3 × 15 s per side | 30 s |
| 28 |  Shoulder external rotation      | 2-3 × 12 per arm    | 30 s |

### 5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

## Weeks 6-7 · Intensity

Less volume, more speed: every rep at maximum quality. Effort 7-8 out of 10.

Power: every heavy set is followed straight away by an explosive movement (contrast).

Muscle development: fewer sets, loads still heavy.

# Session A

## 1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

|   |                                   |                  |           |
|---|-----------------------------------|------------------|-----------|
| 1 | Light jog and running drills      | 3 min            |           |
| 2 | Forward lunge with trunk rotation | 6 per side       |           |
| 3 | Walking hip opener                | 8 per side       |           |
| 4 | Glute bridge                      | 2 × 10           | 15 s      |
| 5 | Plank                             | 2 × 20 s         | 15 s      |
| 6 | Single-leg balance                | 2 × 20 s per leg |           |
| 7 | Small jump, stable landing        | 2 × 5            | 20 s      |
| 8 | Progressive accelerations         | 3 runs           | walk back |

## 2 POWER

15-20 min

|    |                                |                             |                      |
|----|--------------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------|
| 32 | Weighted Bulgarian split squat | 3 × 6 per leg · 3 s descent | back to back         |
| 38 | Loaded squat jump              | 3 × 4                       | 3 min after the pair |

## 3 MUSCLE DEVELOPMENT

15-20 min

|    |          |                     |       |
|----|----------|---------------------|-------|
| 9  | Squat    | 3 × 7 · 3 s descent | 2 min |
| 11 | Push-ups | 3 × 8               | 75 s  |

## 4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

|    |                       |                     |      |
|----|-----------------------|---------------------|------|
| 5  | Plank                 | 2-4 × 30 s          | 30 s |
| 12 | Side plank            | 2-3 × 20 s per side | 20 s |
| 13 | Nordic hamstring curl | 2-3 × 4             | 60 s |

## 5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

## Session B

### 1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

|   |                                                                                                                     |                  |           |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|-----------|
| 1 | Light jog and running drills                                                                                        | 3 min            |           |
| 2 |  Forward lunge with trunk rotation | 6 per side       |           |
| 3 |  Walking hip opener                | 8 per side       |           |
| 4 |  Glute bridge                      | 2 × 10           | 15 s      |
| 5 |  Plank                             | 2 × 20 s         | 15 s      |
| 6 |  Single-leg balance                | 2 × 20 s per leg |           |
| 7 |  Small jump, stable landing        | 2 × 5            | 20 s      |
| 8 | Progressive accelerations                                                                                           | 3 runs           | walk back |

### 2 POWER

15-20 min

|    |                                                                                                       |       |                      |
|----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|----------------------|
| 22 |  Weighted push-ups   | 3 × 6 | back to back         |
| 39 |  Plyometric push-ups | 3 × 4 | 3 min after the pair |

### 3 MUSCLE DEVELOPMENT

15-20 min

|    |                                                                                                       |       |      |
|----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|------|
| 14 |  Hip thrust        | 3 × 9 | 90 s |
| 36 |  Pull-ups (or row) | 3 × 6 | 90 s |

### 4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

|    |                                                                                                         |                  |      |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|------|
| 19 |  Dead bug            | 2-3 × 8 per side | 30 s |
| 20 |  Y-T-W               | 2-3 × 8          | 30 s |
| 21 |  Balance with a ball | 2 × 30 s per leg | 20 s |

### 5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

## Session C

### 1 WARM-UP

10-12 min

|   |                                   |                  |           |
|---|-----------------------------------|------------------|-----------|
| 1 | Light jog and running drills      | 3 min            |           |
| 2 | Forward lunge with trunk rotation | 6 per side       |           |
| 3 | Walking hip opener                | 8 per side       |           |
| 4 | Glute bridge                      | 2 × 10           | 15 s      |
| 5 | Plank                             | 2 × 20 s         | 15 s      |
| 6 | Single-leg balance                | 2 × 20 s per leg |           |
| 7 | Small jump, stable landing        | 2 × 5            | 20 s      |
| 8 | Progressive accelerations         | 3 runs           | walk back |

### 2 POWER

15-20 min

|    |                  |                |      |
|----|------------------|----------------|------|
| 40 | Overhead throw   | 3 × 4          | 75 s |
| 15 | Rotational throw | 3 × 4 per side | 75 s |
| 23 | Box jump         | 3 × 3          | 90 s |

### 3 MUSCLE DEVELOPMENT

15-20 min

|    |                          |                             |      |
|----|--------------------------|-----------------------------|------|
| 24 | Reverse lunge            | 3 × 9 per leg · 3 s descent | 90 s |
| 18 | Plank with shoulder taps | 2 × 10 per side             | 30 s |

### 4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

|    |                                 |                     |      |
|----|---------------------------------|---------------------|------|
| 26 | Single-leg glute bridge         | 2-3 × 10 per leg    | 30 s |
| 27 | Copenhagen plank (knee version) | 2-3 × 15 s per side | 30 s |
| 28 | Shoulder external rotation      | 2-3 × 12 per arm    | 30 s |

### 5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

## Week 8 - Taper

Repeat sessions A, B and C from weeks 6-7 doing **half the sets**, at the same intensity. You will start the season with your club in top shape.

- **Power:** Same loads, same speed.
- **Muscle development:** Same loads.

# The exercises

In the order of the numbers used in your sessions.



**Important: watch each exercise's animation before doing it.** Tap the eye next to its name. The animation shows what the text cannot: the exact position, the direction of the movement, the rhythm and the footwork. Do not just read the program, especially for an exercise you do not know: this is what makes every session effective and safe.

## 1 Light jog and running drills

Light jog, alternating side shuffles, high knees and butt kicks.

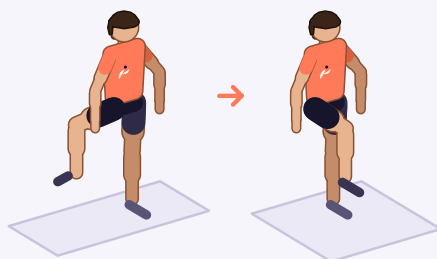
**Key points:** Start slowly, then gradually pick up the pace.



## 2 Forward lunge with trunk rotation

Take a big step forward, lower into a lunge, then turn your trunk towards the front leg. Come back and switch legs.

**Key points:** Front knee above the ankle, slow rotation.



## 3 Walking hip opener

As you walk, lift your knee out to the side as if stepping over a fence, bring it round in front of you at the same height, and put your foot down one step further. Switch legs.

**Key points:** Upright trunk, big circle with the knee.



4



## Glute bridge

On your back, knees bent, feet on the floor, lift your hips until shoulders, hips and knees are in line, then lower.

**Key points:** Squeeze your glutes at the top, do not arch your lower back. Also contract your pelvic floor (as if holding in urine): it protects against leaks, especially for women and older people.



5



## Plank

On your forearms and toes, body in a straight line from head to heels.

**Key points:** Squeeze your glutes and abs, breathe normally.

**Easier:** Knees on the floor.



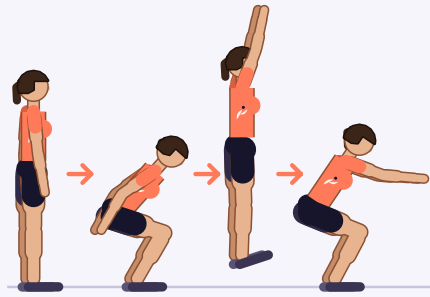
6



## Single-leg balance

On one foot, knee slightly bent, arms relaxed: hold the position without moving. To progress: close your eyes, then stand on a cushion.

**Key points:** The knee stays over the foot, the pelvis level.



7



### Small jump, stable landing

Small jump on the spot, land softly on both feet and hold the position for 2 seconds.

**Key points:** Land on the balls of your feet, knees bent and in line with your toes: they never cave inwards. In the air, pull your toes up towards your shins (locked ankle), ready for the landing.

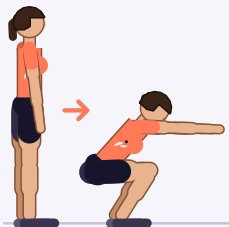
8

### Progressive accelerations

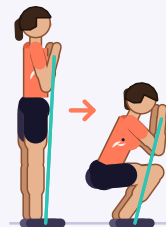
Run 15 m, building up speed: 60 %, then 80 %, then 90 % of your top speed. Walk back.

**Key points:** Relaxed, shoulders loose.

At home



With a band



9



### Squat

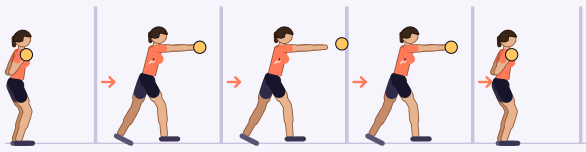
Feet shoulder-width apart, lower as if sitting down, thighs at least parallel to the floor, then stand up. When it gets easy: a weighted backpack held tight against your chest.

**With a band:** Band under your feet, held at your shoulders: it resists as you stand up.

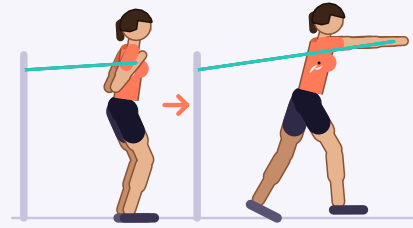
**Key points:** Straight back, heels on the floor, knees in line with your feet.

**Easier:** Sit down on a chair and stand up.

At home



With a band



## 10 Two-handed ball throw

Facing an outside wall, handball or basketball at your chest, throw as hard as you can. Without a ball: plyometric push-ups.

**With a band:** Band anchored behind you at chest height: push forward as fast as possible.

**Key points:** Push with your legs and arms at the same time.



## 11 Push-ups

Hands slightly wider than your shoulders, body braced, lower your chest close to the floor then push. Harder: feet raised on a chair.

**With a band:** Band across your back, held under each hand: it resists as you push.

**Key points:** Elbows at 45° from your body, the hips do not sag.

**Easier:** Hands on a table, or knees on the floor.



## 12 Side plank

On your side, on one forearm and the edge of your foot, body in line, hips high.

**Key points:** The hips do not drop.

**Easier:** Knees on the floor.



## 13 Nordic hamstring curl

Kneeling on a cushion, feet anchored under the sofa or held by another person, lean forward as slowly as possible, body straight. Catch yourself with your hands, then push back up with your hands.

**Key points:** Hips extended: the body stays straight from the knees to the head.

**Easier:** Shorter descent.



## 14 Hip thrust

Upper back against the sofa, feet on the floor, lift your hips until shoulders, hips and knees are in line. When it gets easy: on one leg.

**With a band:** Band across your hips, held to the floor by your hands on each side.

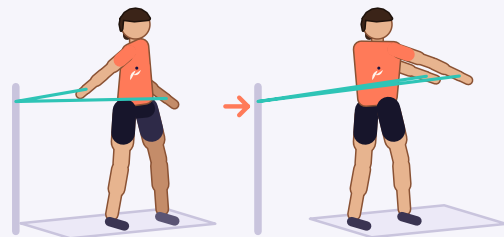
**Key points:** Squeeze your glutes at the top for one second. Also contract your pelvic floor (as if holding in urine): it protects against leaks, especially for women and older people.

**Easier:** Glute bridge on the floor.

### At home



### With a band

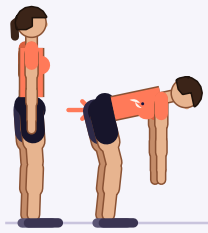


## 15 Rotational throw

Side-on to an outside wall, ball held at your hip, pivot and throw sideways, like a shot. Without a ball: fast trunk rotations, arms straight.

**With a band:** Band anchored to the side at hip height: rotate your trunk as fast as possible, pulling the band.

**Key points:** The movement starts from the hips, not the arms.



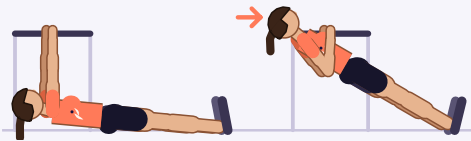
## 16 Romanian deadlift

On one leg (the other goes back), trunk tipping forward, flat back, until you feel the stretch behind your thigh, then stand up. Harder: a bag in your hand.

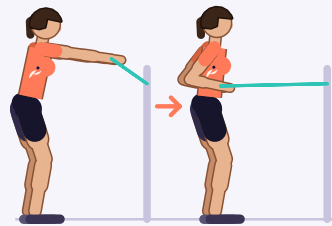
**With a band:** On both legs, band under your feet, held with both hands: tip your trunk forward, flat back, and stand up.

**Key points:** Flat back from start to finish, the load slides along your legs.

### At home



### With a band



## 17 Inverted row

Lying under a sturdy table, hands on the edge, body straight: pull your chest towards the table, then lower. Other option: one-arm row with a weighted backpack.

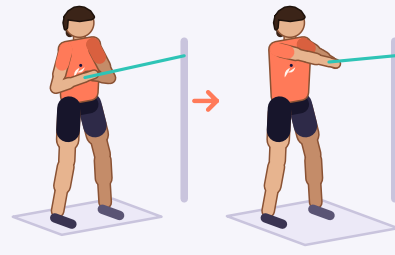
**With a band:** Band anchored to a door at chest height: pull your elbows back.

**Key points:** Pull with your back, the shoulder blade moves towards the spine.

At home



With a band

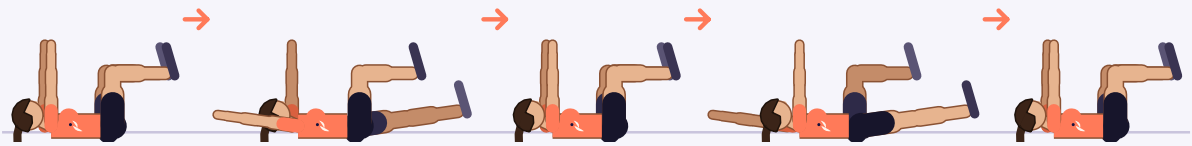


## 18 Plank with shoulder taps

In a straight-arm plank, feet apart: touch the opposite shoulder with one hand, then the other, without your hips moving.

**With a band:** Pallof press: band anchored to the side at chest height, press your arms out in front of you without letting your trunk rotate.

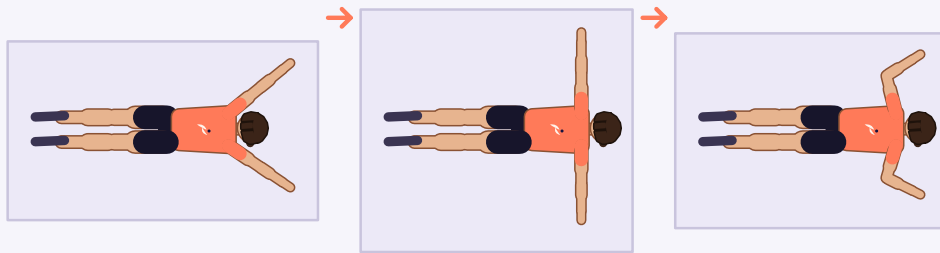
**Key points:** Resist the rotation: this is a core exercise.



## 19 Dead bug

On your back, arms straight up towards the ceiling, knees bent at 90°. Extend one arm and the opposite leg without touching the floor, then switch sides.

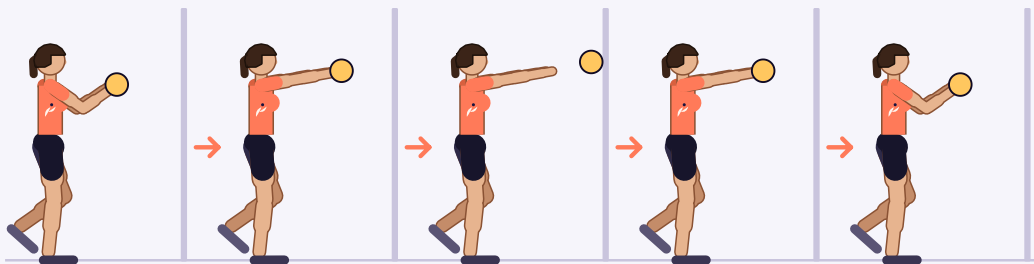
**Key points:** Your lower back stays pressed to the floor.



## 20 Y-T-W

Lying face down, forehead on a towel. Lift your arms off the floor to draw three letters with your body: Y (arms straight, diagonally above your head), T (arms out to the sides), then W (elbows bent, pulled in close to your ribs). Hold each letter for 2 seconds, squeezing your shoulder blades.

**Key points:** Thumbs towards the ceiling, no arching.



## 21 Balance with a ball

On one leg, on a folded cushion, throw a ball against a wall and catch it.

**Key points:** The standing knee stays in line.

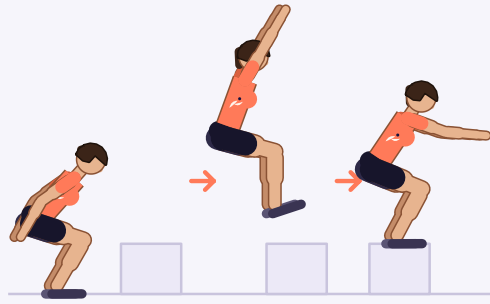


## 22 Weighted push-ups

Push-ups with a weighted backpack. Without a bag: feet raised, 3-second descent.

**With a band:** Push-ups with a strong band across your back.

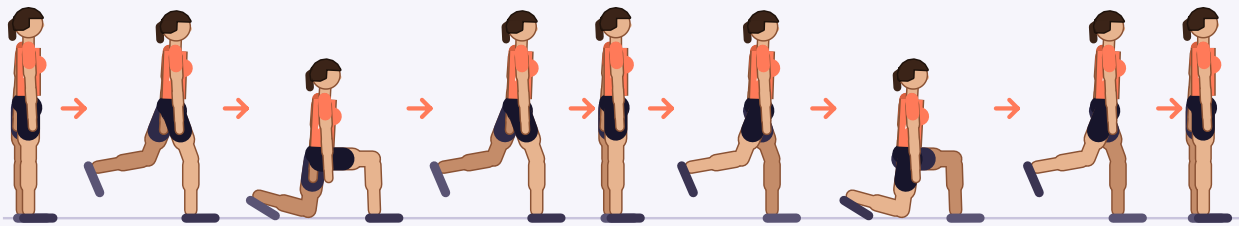
**Key points:** Shoulder blades squeezed, explosive push.



## 23 Box jump

Jump onto a stair step or a very stable bench, land softly, step back down. Without a stable support: squat jump.

**Key points:** Jump high, not far. Stepping down protects your tendons. In the air, pull your toes up towards your shins (locked ankle), ready for the landing.



## 24 Reverse lunge

Step one leg back and lower until the back knee almost touches the floor. Come back by pushing through the front leg, then switch legs (the front foot stays planted). When it gets easy: a weighted backpack.

**With a band:** Band under your front foot, held at your shoulders.

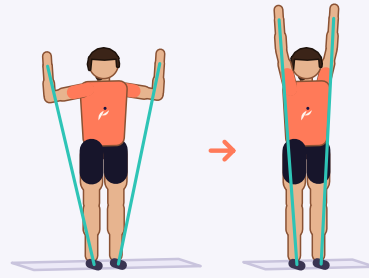
**Key points:** Upright trunk, front knee above the ankle.

**Easier:** With support (wall, chair).

At home



With a band



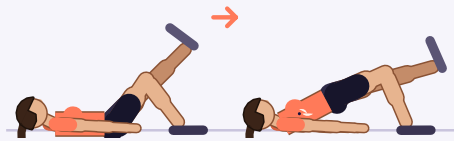
## 25 Pike push-ups

Hands on the floor, hips up (body in an upside-down V): bend your elbows to bring the top of your head towards the floor, then push.

**With a band:** Standing on the band, press it overhead, then lower back to your shoulders.

**Key points:** Tight core, do not arch your lower back.

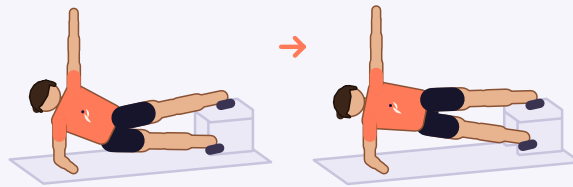
**Easier:** Feet closer to your hands, shorter range.



## 26 Single-leg glute bridge

Like the glute bridge, with one leg straight in the air.

**Key points:** The pelvis stays level. Also contract your pelvic floor (as if holding in urine): it protects against leaks, especially for women and older people.



## 27 Copenhagen plank

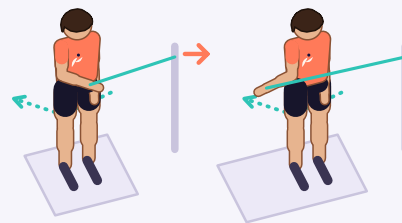
On your side, on your forearm, top leg resting on the sofa or a chair (at the knee, or at the foot to make it harder). Lift your hips and hold the position.

**Key points:** Body in line: the inside of the top thigh does the work.

### At home



### With a band



## 28 Shoulder external rotation

Lying on your side, top elbow tucked against your waist and bent at 90°, a water bottle in your hand, forearm resting in front of your belly: lift your forearm towards the ceiling by pivoting around the elbow (the hand moves away from your belly), then lower slowly.

**With a band:** Standing, band anchored to the side: elbow tucked in, move your forearm outwards.

**Key points:** The elbow does not move, 2 seconds on the way back.

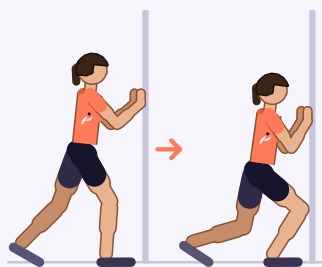
**Easier:** Without a band.



## 29 90/90 hip mobility

Seated on the floor, hands on the floor behind you, feet flat and wider than your hips, knees up. Let both knees drop to the same side into the 90/90 position: front leg bent at 90° in front of you, back leg bent at 90° out to the side. Bring the knees back up through the middle and over to the other side, like windscreen wipers.

**Key points:** Upright trunk, slow movement. Only go as far as your hips allow, pain-free.



## 30 Ankle mobility at the wall

Facing a wall, foot 10 cm away, drive your knee forward to touch the wall without lifting your heel.

**Key points:** Heel glued to the floor. Move your foot back if it is easy.



## 31 Upper back rotation

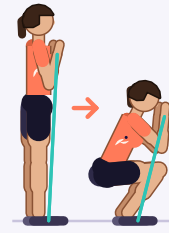
On all fours, hands under your shoulders. Rotate your upper back as you reach one arm towards the ceiling, following your hand with your eyes, then bring it back down and do the same with the other arm.

**Key points:** The pelvis does not move.

At home



With a band

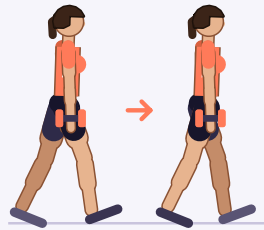


### 32 Weighted Bulgarian split squat

Back foot resting on the sofa or a chair, weighted backpack on your back: lower on the front leg over 3 seconds, then stand up as fast as possible.

**With a band:** Squat with a strong band under your feet, held at your shoulders, 2-second pause at the bottom.

**Key points:** Controlled descent, stand up as fast as possible.



### 33 Farmer's walk

Walk with a heavy load in each hand: shopping bags, packs of water or water containers. If it is too light, double the distance.

**Key points:** Shoulders down, upright trunk, steady steps.



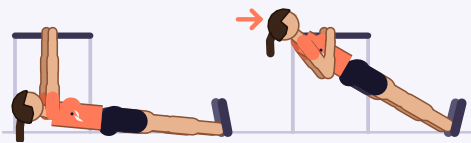
### 34 Single-leg hip thrust

Upper back on the sofa, one leg straight in the air: drive your hips up forcefully and hold for 2 seconds at the top.

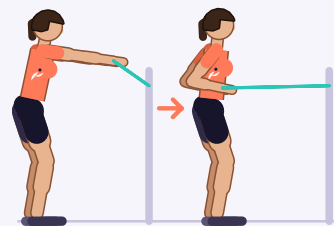
**With a band:** On both legs, strong band across your hips, pause at the top.

**Key points:** Push through your heels, lock your glutes at the top. Also contract your pelvic floor (as if holding in urine): it protects against leaks, especially for women and older people.

At home



With a band



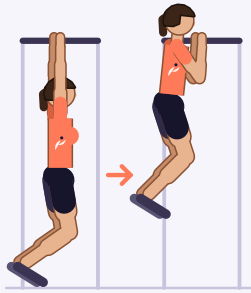
### 35 Inverted row, feet raised

Under a sturdy table, feet on a chair: pull your chest quickly towards the table, lower over 3 seconds.

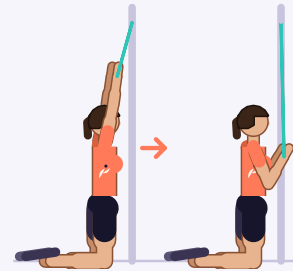
**With a band:** Row with a strong band anchored to a door, 1-second pause with the elbows back.

**Key points:** Pull fast, lower slowly.

At home



With a band



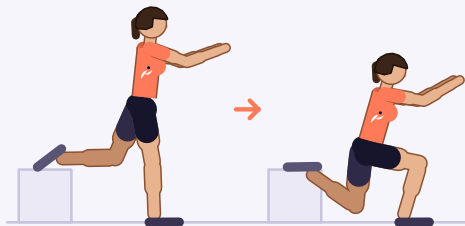
### 36 Pull-ups

On a doorway bar: hanging, pull until your chin is over the bar, then lower. Without a bar: inverted row under a table.

**With a band:** Kneeling, band anchored high: pull your elbows down, close to your body. With a bar: the band under your knees to help you.

**Key points:** Controlled descent, arms almost straight at the bottom.

**Easier:** With a band, or only the slow descent.

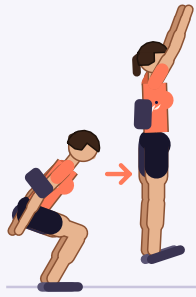


### 37 Bulgarian split squat

Back foot resting on the sofa or a chair, lower on the front leg then stand back up. When it gets easy: a weighted backpack.

**With a band:** Band under your front foot, held at your shoulders.

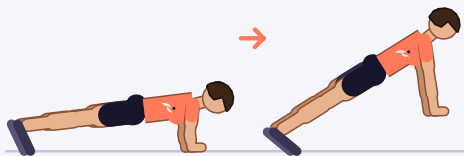
**Key points:** The front leg does the work, the back foot is only for balance.



### 38 Loaded squat jump

Squat jump with a light backpack (3 to 5 kg). Without a bag: normal squat jump.

**Key points:** Stable landing, knees in line. In the air, pull your toes up towards your shins (locked ankle), ready for the landing.

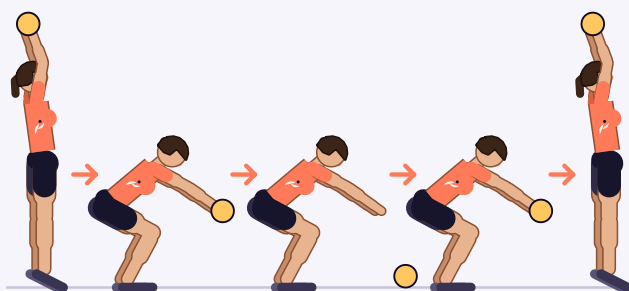


### 39 Plyometric push-ups

Push hard enough for your hands to leave the floor on every rep.

**Key points:** Land with your arms slightly bent.

**Easier:** Hands on a bench.



### 40 Overhead throw

Handball or basketball above your head, slam it hard into the floor or against an outside wall.

**Key points:** Your whole body takes part, tight core.